

Overall Introduction

For Task E, my goal was to create a lesson plan that could be included as part of the Bike and Pedestrian Safety Kit Loan Program. Since schools, parks, and community organizations will be able to check out these kits, I wanted the lesson to be easy for different instructors to teach while still being interactive and engaging for middle school students.

I specifically designed this lesson for grades 6 through 8 because students at this age are becoming more independent. Many are walking, biking, or riding e-bikes around their neighborhoods or to school, so I wanted to focus on real-life situations they may experience every day.

One important revision I made after receiving feedback was dividing the lesson into **two separate lessons**. This allows students to first learn the safety concepts in the classroom before applying those skills during an outdoor Bike Skills Course. Separating the instruction and practice gives students more time to build confidence and safely demonstrate what they have learned.

Learning Objectives

I wanted the learning objectives to build on one another instead of simply listing safety topics.

Students first learn basic bicycle, e-bike, and pedestrian safety before practicing more advanced skills. They learn how to properly fit a helmet, complete the ABC Quick Check before riding, recognize traffic signs, demonstrate bicycle hand signals, and safely share roads, sidewalks, bike lanes, and crosswalks.

I also expanded the e-bike content because e-bikes are becoming increasingly popular among middle school students. Students learn about the differences between traditional bicycles and e-bikes, how increased speed affects stopping distance, why riders should slow down around pedestrians, and basic battery safety.

These objectives prepare students for both the classroom lesson and the outdoor riding activities.

Materials

I chose materials that encourage hands-on learning because middle school students tend to stay engaged when they can actively participate.

The helmets allow students to practice proper helmet fitting instead of simply hearing about it.

ABC Quick Check cards help students remember the inspection process before every ride.

Traffic sign cards and hand signal reference cards reinforce the rules of the road.

Safety cones create a controlled Bike Skills Course where students can practice riding techniques safely.

I also included an e-bike classification poster, speed comparison visuals, and scenario cards to help students understand how riding an e-bike differs from riding a traditional bicycle.

Lesson 1: Classroom Instruction

Introduction (10 Minutes)

To begin Lesson 1, I would ask students how they usually travel to school or around their neighborhood.

This serves as an icebreaker while helping students connect the lesson to their own experiences. Whether they walk, ride a bicycle, ride an e-bike, use a scooter, or get dropped off, everyone is a pedestrian at some point.

After students share their responses, I explain that today's lesson will focus on bicycle, pedestrian, and e-bike safety and that these skills help keep both themselves and others safe.

Activity 1: Helmet Fit & ABC Quick Check

I decided to begin with helmet fitting because it is one of the easiest and most important safety habits students can develop.

Students learn how a helmet should sit level on the head, rest about two fingers above the eyebrows, have straps that form a "V" under each ear, and fit snugly under the chin.

After practicing helmet fitting with a partner, students move into the ABC Quick Check.

The ABC Quick Check stands for:

- Air
- Brakes
- Chain

Students inspect a bicycle using the checklist provided and learn that performing a quick inspection before every ride can help prevent crashes caused by mechanical problems.

Activity 2: Rules of the Road, E-Bike Safety & Shared Spaces

Next, students learn how to safely share roads, sidewalks, bike lanes, and crosswalks with others.

Students review common traffic signs, right-of-way rules, and bicycle hand signals because communication is an important part of safe riding.

I also expanded this section to include more e-bike education.

Students discuss:

- The three classes of e-bikes
- Why e-bikes travel faster than traditional bicycles
- How increased speed affects stopping distance
- Why riders should slow down near pedestrians
- The importance of wearing a properly fitted helmet
- Why distracted riding is dangerous
- Basic battery safety and proper charging practices

Students also discuss different riding scenarios to encourage responsible decision-making.

Lesson 1 Conclusion

To conclude Lesson 1, students reflect on what they learned by answering questions such as:

- What's one thing you'll always check before riding?
- What's one difference between a bicycle and an e-bike?

Students then complete an exit ticket to assess their understanding before moving on to the outdoor lesson.

Lesson 2: Bike Skills Course (Outdoor)

For Lesson 2, students apply everything they learned during the classroom lesson.

Instead of learning new information, they practice the skills through a Bike Skills Course that reinforces safe riding habits.

Station 1: Helmet Fit Check

Students work with a partner to confirm that helmets fit correctly before riding.

This reinforces the helmet-fitting skills learned during Lesson 1.

Station 2: Hand Signal Practice

Students demonstrate left-turn, right-turn, and stop signals before beginning the course.

This helps build confidence before riding in situations where communication with drivers is important.

Station 3: Obstacle Course

Students ride through cones while practicing:

- Smooth starts
- Controlled turns
- Safe stopping
- Maintaining an appropriate speed

This provides hands-on practice in a safe environment.

Station 4: Traffic Sign Challenge

Students stop at different traffic signs throughout the course and explain what each sign means before continuing.

This reinforces the classroom discussion about traffic signs and right-of-way.

Station 5: Safe Pedestrian Crossing

Students practice safely crossing the street after parking their bicycle.

They demonstrate looking left-right-left, making eye contact with drivers when appropriate, and crossing safely.

Station 6: E-Bike Decision Challenge

Students evaluate different riding scenarios and decide whether each one is safe or unsafe.

Examples include:

- Riding too fast on a crowded sidewalk
- Wearing a helmet
- Using a phone while riding
- Carrying another passenger
- Slowing down near pedestrians
- Obeying traffic signs and signals

Students explain their reasoning, helping reinforce responsible decision-making.

Lesson 2 Conclusion

To end the lesson, students reflect on one new safety habit they plan to use the next time they walk, ride a bicycle, or ride an e-bike.

This encourages students to apply what they learned beyond the classroom and reinforces that safe choices help protect both themselves and others.

Assessment

I chose to assess students through participation and demonstrations rather than a traditional written test because this lesson focuses on practical safety skills.

Students demonstrate their understanding by:

- Properly fitting a helmet
- Completing the ABC Quick Check
- Demonstrating correct hand signals
- Participating in classroom discussions
- Successfully completing the Bike Skills Course
- Completing the exit ticket

Since the goal is to build real-world safety skills, performance-based assessment provides a more meaningful measure of student learning.

Overall, I wanted this lesson to be interactive, practical, and easy for different instructors to teach as part of the Bike and Pedestrian Safety Kit Loan Program. My goal was to create activities that help students build skills they can immediately apply outside the classroom. I also made sure to include more e-bike education because e-bike use is becoming more common among middle school students, and understanding how they differ from traditional bicycles is an important part of keeping students and the community safe. I wanted students to leave the lesson not only knowing the rules but also feeling more confident making safe decisions whenever they're walking, biking, or riding an e-bike.